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A psychometric validation of the happiness at workplace scale

Mansi Rastogi

Abstract

Purpose – *With intention to promote growth of happiness literature in non-western settings and facilitate positive interventions at workplace, the purpose of this paper is to examine the psychometric properties and validate the short version of happiness at workplace (S-HAW) scale using knowledge workers' sample in the Indian context.*

Design/methodology/approach – *The S-HAW scale was validated using data from 226 Indian knowledge workers from public and private sector organisations. The mixed-mode approach was used for collecting data, whereas factor structures, reliability and validity scores were also examined with the help of SPSS AMOS 21. The study included initial descriptive analysis, item analysis, exploratory factor analysis and confirmatory factor analysis.*

Findings – *The results of the study discovered that psychometric properties of the S-HAW scale were similar to those of originally developed scale when applied in the Indian context. Hence, the higher-order structure was retained in Indian settings.*

Originality/value – *Despite the changes in work-related values and societal structures between Western and Asian nations, this study provides a significant contribution to empirically confirming that the different cultural scales can also show good fits in Collectivist cultures. The study can bridge the gap between Asian and Western nations with the uniform measure of HAW. Thus, more cross-cultural studies usually comparative in nature welcomed with S-HAW Indian version scale for knowledge workers.*

Keywords India, Culture, Knowledge workers, Instrument validation, Happiness at workplace, Shorter scale

Paper type Research paper

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1. Introduction

Work and family domains play a crucial role in an individual's life (French *et al.*, 2018). On a day-to-day basis, a person usually spends most of the day at the work, maybe for earning a living, fame, satisfaction, identity, etc., thus spending a great share of their life at the workplace (Gavin and Mason, 2004; Meyers, 2007). Gavin and Mason (2004, p. 181) mentioned in their study, "Work, at its core, is a search for 'daily meaning as well as daily bread.' so found author Studs Terkel in his classic 1972 book Working". The supremacy of work in the Indian lifestyle can be well understood with the recent research outcomes generated by Swiss investment bank UBS. The bank marked two Indian cities in the top four cities of the world with the highest working hours a year. Branded as the financial capital of India republic, Mumbai grabbed the first place with 3,315 working hours per year, whereas New Delhi, the national capital of India, settled at 2,511 working hours per year (Moneycontrol.com, 2018). Whether it is work domain or family domain, happiness is considered as a high-priority goal of our lives (Diener, 2000).

Given the above background, where importance of work domain for an average Indian employee is highlighted, we combine work with happiness. The present study aims to promote happiness at work by preparing a reliable, valid and composite measure for examining happiness at workplace among Indian employees.

India, as the most preferred outsourcing hub, and a dependable cost advantage and process efficiency provider to global businesses, has immense potential to contribute to the growth of economy globally (Insight Success, NA). With the acknowledgement of the current trends,

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i.e., knowledge economy, a sheer demand of efficient and skilled knowledge workers/ professionals is witnessed all across the globe (All India Management Association, 2019). Despite the strategic significance of the knowledge workers as the non-conventional fuel for knowledge-based economies, very few studies have addressed the challenges of knowledge workers in the existing literature (Daniel *et al.*, 2018; Shujahat *et al.*, 2019). Thus, respecting the need of the hour, it becomes urgent and important to provide a statistically validated measure to industry and academic researchers for measuring the level of happiness at workplace among knowledge workers in India.

Primarily, the study is organised into three sections: introduction, justification of the study, description of measure, followed by analyses and findings. The introduction includes the conceptualisation of the happiness at workplace construct along with the importance. Furthermore, the justification and analyses body establish the rationale for using this short scale (Salas-Vallina and Alegre, 2018), reasoning of validation in Indian settings based on extant literature followed by the details of used scale. Along with it, reliability, factor structures, validity scores are measured using EFA and CFA in SPSS AMOS 21. Finally, the study ends with a findings section comprising of discussion about the obtained results, limitations and conclusion.

2. The need of the study

With greater recognition of the importance of positive organisational behaviour where strengths are focused and eventually developed, Seligman (2000) emphasised the need for a valid and reliable scale for understanding about human strengths, whereas Harrison *et al.* (2014) realised that the positive attitudes can be measured adequately using a higher order construct as a minimum three well-established and extensively tested paradigms. Responding to these calls, few researchers designed and validated the happiness at workplace scale (Salas-Vallina, Alegre and Fernandez, 2017; Salas-Vallina and Fernandez, 2017; Salas-Vallina, López-Cabrales, Alegre and Fernández, 2017).

In addition, even with the accessibility of other happiness at workplace scales (Lutterbie and Pryce-Jones, 2013; Van Katwyk *et al.*, 2000; Singh and Aggarwal, 2018; Lyubomirsky and Lepper, 1999), along with a recently developed happiness at workplace scale in the Indian context (Singh and Aggarwal, 2018), some scholars may question about the utility and nobility of this study. Addressing the given background, it is important to indicate here that why this study is aimed at the validation of the short version of happiness at the workplace scale in the Indian context? Keeping the aforesaid concerns, the researcher presents the significance at three levels. First, why short scale of happiness at workplace (S-HAW) is imperative? Second, why shortened version of HAW measure is important in Indian settings? And, why the study used the sample of knowledge workers for validation?

2.1 Rationale for using S-HAW

This study adopted an S-HAW which is developed by Salas-Vallina and Alegre (2018) for the following reasons– First, it is mostly observed that lengthier surveys consume more time to complete that often results into possibility of missing data and also relatively higher refusal rates as compared to shorter surveys (Stanton *et al.*, 2002). Second, organisations also need surveys that are not complicated and take lesser time to be filled because employers do not appreciate if employees spend much time away from their work in the name of survey participation (Stanton *et al.*, 2002). Third, a shortened validated version of HAW scale is also required by Indian organisational researchers because many studies have revealed the importance of happiness construct from Indian perspective (Nagar, 2018; Biswas-Diener *et al.*, 2012) conceptually, yet there is dearth of appropriate short instrument for measuring the happiness specially at workplaces. The available instruments are either developed in western settings or are extensively lengthy (Lutterbie and Pryce-Jones, 2013; Van Katwyk *et al.*, 2000; Singh and Aggarwal, 2018; Lyubomirsky and Lepper, 1999). Fourth, among the available happiness at workplace scales, some instruments project well-being via the lenses of subjective dimension that focuses on happiness, in general, as compared to happiness with special

reference to work. Hedonic elements include relatively more general level of happiness (for e.g. Lyubomirsky and Lepper, 1999). Moreover, in the Indian context “*Ananda* (Happiness) is not something that is achieved in an objective sense, but something that is realised” (Nagar, 2018, p. 183). Srivastava and Misra (2011) indicated in their study that happiness is not associated with external objects because if it were so, then the related object would have been the source of happiness for everyone in the world (eudaimonic perspective). Rather, the “Indian tradition does not relate avoidance of pain to happiness; rather, it places emphasis on self-regulation for attainment of everlasting happiness” (Nagar, 2018, p. 184). This scale comprises of both hedonic and eudaimonic foundations with the incorporation of work engagement, job satisfaction and organisational commitment (Salas-Vallina and Alegre, 2018). Fifth, the available measures include direct questions (Lyubomirsky and Lepper, 1999) that often create confusion, hesitation among respondents and consequently affect quality of answers, whereas few scales were identified as inappropriate due to their long list of items consequently limiting the efficiency of the measurement (Singh and Aggarwal, 2018). Thus, the presently used the S-HAW scale consisted of practical dimensions such as working conditions along with cognitive aspects apart from the subjective ones. Thus, the indirect approach of items enabled this comprehensive S-HAW scale appropriate for measuring happiness at the work place in the least possible time.

Many studies used extremely long instruments for measuring happiness at the workplace in their studies for example Sousa and Porto (2015) used the Well-Being at Work Scale – WBWS (Paschoal and Tamayo, 2008), whereas Krause (2013) used IZA evaluation data set (Caliendo *et al.*, 2011) for the examination of mechanisms between happiness and reemployment. Recently, Williams *et al.* (2015) specified the absence of any composite instrument for measuring work happiness in a recent work. Thus, the existing well-established measure was selected containing three elements that satisfies the above highlighted concerns such as short in size, combination of hedonic and eudaimonic elements, indirect approach and easily understandable. This scale is completely based on widely accepted Fisher’s (2010) conceptualisation of happiness at workplace construct and includes three crucial dimensions related to workplace, i.e., job engagement, job satisfaction and affective organisational commitment. The popularity of Fisher’s conceptualisation-based dimensions can be well understood with the acknowledgement of the observation that prior to the development of this short scale, many studies adhered to these three dimensions for measuring happiness at workplace (for e.g. Williams *et al.*, 2015; Salas-Vallina, Alegre and Fernandez, 2017; Salas-Vallina and Fernandez, 2017; Salas-Vallina, López-Cabrales, Alegre and Fernández, 2017).

2.2 Requirement of S-HAW in Indian settings

2.2.1 The strategic importance of India and its knowledge workers as a global player. Recognised as an emerging giant in world economy (Nigam, 2017), IMF has labelled India as the fastest rising economy among newly emerging economies in 2018 (Jha, 2018), whereas Global CEOs ranked India as fifth most attractive investment destination across the globe (Sidhratha, 2018). In addition to this, the country is predicted to be the youngest nation by 2020 in the whole world (Shivakumar, 2013). Indian workforce, also branded as Indian talent, establishes a unique place in talent market due to its sharp mathematical, analytical skills, decent English-speaking abilities and cheap salaries costs (Rastogi *et al.*, 2016). These factors coupled with supportive government policies make India as one of the greatest outsourcing destinations across the globe. Additionally, the growth paradigm of developed economies in globalised era requires another kind of fuel named as knowledge workers and skilled professionals for their strategic incessant growth (All India Management Association, 2019). In the era of highly competitive knowledge-oriented tight labour markets where fast work developments redefine the nature of work, the task of motivating and retaining knowledge workers has emerged as a core challenge for organisations (Horwitz *et al.*, 2003). Researchers indicate that happiness/overall wellbeing of employees has strong relationship with their motivation levels and retention rates (Ryan and Deci, 2000; Nix *et al.*, 1999). In a way, the motivation and retention tendencies of knowledge workers can be determined by keeping a track on their happiness levels (Wright, 2010). Various researchers have highlighted the importance of examining the workplace happiness in different cultures for example (Joo and Lee, 2017) in South Korea; (Gavin and Mason, 2004)

in USA; and (Zyl, 2013) in Africa. Thus, with the abundant quality workforce, India can be considered as a great business opportunity destination and a global talent hub with size (availability of a number of employees) and excellence of the workforce, and therefore, it becomes strategically important to validate the S-HAW measure using the sample of knowledge workers in India.

2.2.2 Unique work values in India. Many studies addressed the centrality of work in the collectivistic Indian society (Hofstede, 2011; Rastogi *et al.*, 2018, 2019; Leichtman *et al.*, 2003). Here, work refers to only paid work. But the literature confirms that work life (job) is not restricted to earning a living or buying a beer like many societies (Gavin and Mason, 2004) and, it plays a more vital and superior part in lives of Indians, for example, an individual has the motivation to get involved in paid work to support family monetarily (Baral and Bhargava, 2011). Not only this, a noble job in the Indian society enhances the social prestige and brings fame to the whole family, whereas a slandered work or failure in a job role would bring shame to the entire family (Sinha and Sinha, 1990; Rastogi *et al.*, 2016). Furthermore, the Indian society is characterised as a highly value-centred nation in the twenty-first century because family continues to take the prime decision-making role regarding selection of the employer or organisation (Hatum, 2013). Nicholson and Sahay (2001) compared Indian employees to British employees in a study and revealed that Indians showed more willingness to work overtime for the completion of the task because they feel accountable to their superiors.

In the Indian collectivist society, people are typically close with their family, friends and also with their colleagues (Sahay and Walsham, 1997; Sinha and Sinha 1990). Unlike individualistic societies, collectivistic cultures value belongingness, harmony and cooperation more (Triandis, 1995). Consequently, Indians like fewer, more intimate and long-standing relations (Sinha, 1997). Infact, Sinha and Sinha (1990, p. 709) also observed that Indian employees believe in personal relationships more, and hence, they somewhat accommodate than confront each other.

Accordingly, with above-mentioned facts that mark India as the fastest rising economy (Jha, 2018), an emerging global giant (Nigam, 2017), and the fifth most attractive investment destination (Sidhratha, 2018) across the world, the nation can be labelled as a true powerful global player that plays a strategically important role in global business processes. With the unique values related to work, the newly developed S-HAW scale by Salas-Vallina and Alegre (2018) would be inappropriate for measuring happiness at the workplace in the unique Indian context without any prior validation because this scale is theoretically developed and empirically validated in Spain. Work values vary culture to culture (Rastogi *et al.*, 2018, 2019). As what is liked by a person in one culture may not be appreciated by another person in a different culture (Nicholson and Sahay, 2001). Hence, bearing in mind the strategic significance in the global economy, this study offers a composite and concise statistical tool for determining the happiness at the workplace in unique societal settings of India.

3. The conceptualisation of happiness at workplace

The concept of happiness at the workplace is derived from positive psychology that promotes focus towards solutions rather than criticising the problems. As clear from the term itself, it is associated with positive constructs such as pleasure, satisfaction, well-being and happiness, mostly concentrating on the positive aspects of human lives as compared to negative aspects. Positive psychology is defined as “a science of positive subjective experience, positive individual traits, and positive institutions” that aims to improve quality of life (Seligman and Csikszentmihalyi, 2000, p. 5). The concept gained more popularity when the power of positivity in lives was identified and people felt interested in experiencing positive experiences in everyday circumstances.

Primarily, it is important to note that the concept of well-being can be understood using two general perspectives: hedonic approach and eudaimonic approach. “The hedonic approach, which focuses on happiness and defines well-being in terms of pleasure attainment and pain

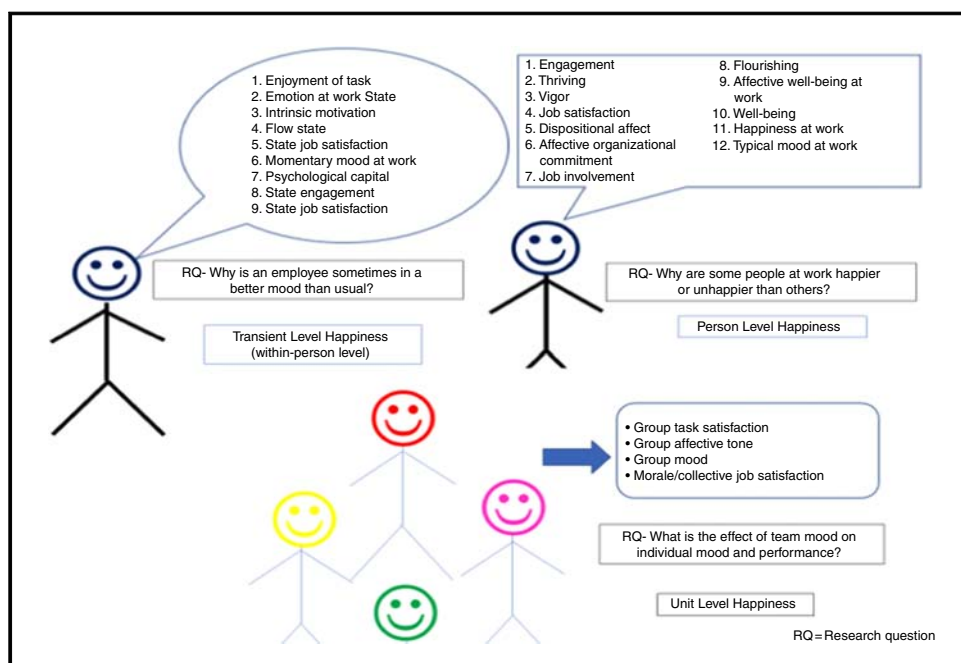
avoidance; and the eudaimonic approach, which focuses on meaning and self-realisation and defines well-being in terms of the degree to which a person is fully functioning” (Ryan and Deci, 2001, p. 141). It is surprising to note that though the construct of well-being gained much popularity among researchers and could be termed as a much-explored aspect in the academic literature, the extant literature of review reveals the absence of significant exploration of happiness construct especially in the workplace context (Salas-Vallina *et al.*, 2018).

The construct of happiness is often used interchangeably with subjective well-being in organisational behaviour research (Carr, 2004; Sheldon and Lyubomirsky, 2004). There is no contradiction in acknowledging that happiness is a highly subjective construct that has many definitions, and subsequently lead to the absence of unanimity among definitions. Some studies defined happiness as global judgments of one’s life, satisfaction with one’s personal life, the prevalence of positive moods and emotions, and low levels of negative affect (Diener *et al.*, 1999). In contrast, the literature displays that it is very tough and sometimes almost impossible to name or explain all emotions in words, regardless of the significance of optimistic attitudes at work. The objective of this investigation is restricted to happiness related to workplace; thus, this study defines happiness at the workplace as happy feelings towards the job itself, the job characteristics and the organisation as a whole as happiness at the workplace that subsequently involves different attitudes at work (Fisher, 2010).

With the recognition of the power of positivity, researchers have shown ample interest in happiness at the workplace (Fisher, 2010). It is interesting to know that Fisher (2010) theorised happiness at the workplace at three levels, namely, transient, person and unit (see Figure 1). The very first transient level denotes within-person level happiness at the workplace. As depicted in Figure 1, the constructs indicate momentary moods and emotions that individuals might experience for the extremely short duration of time. For the unit level, the happiness revolves around working groups and teams.

In line with the objective of the present study, the primary focus of the investigation is happiness at the workplace at the individual level (person level). As indicated in Figure 1, the majority of positive attitude constructs lie in individual-level happiness at work. Out of 12 constructs, the three constructs named, job satisfaction, job engagement and affective organisational commitment are mostly used by happiness at workplace research studies globally (Salas-Vallina, Alegre and

Figure 1 Different levels of happiness at workplace



Fernandez, 2017; Salas-Vallina and Fernandez, 2017; Salas-Vallina, López-Cabrales, Alegre and Fernández, 2017). The details of dimensions as proposed by Fisher (2010) are displayed in Table I. Each dimension is briefly discussed below.

3.1 Job satisfaction

The literature witnesses job satisfaction as one of the most imperative and widely researched variables in the industrial and organisational psychology domain (Locke, 1976). Wilson and Rosenfeld (1990) revealed significant reasons for the unending and ever increasing popularity of job satisfaction construct among the academic researchers and behavioural scientists. They pointed out its positive as well as negative attitudes towards work that possibly exert influential effects on many forms of organisational behaviour. Locke (1969) defined job satisfaction as a pleasurable or positive emotional state resulting from an appraisal of one's job. Many studies have demonstrated the importance of job satisfaction, and specified how job satisfaction leads to various organisational outcomes such as absenteeism and turnover, productivity, efficiency, employee relations and job performance (Baron, 1986; Maghrabi, 1999; Weiss and Cropanzano, 1996).

3.2 Job Engagement

Job engagement refers to an optimistic status of mind at one's workplace. Kahn (1990) defined job engagement as "the harnessing of organisational members' selves to their work roles" (p. 694). The concept of engagement can be easily understood by comparing it with disengagement. Kahn (1990, p. 694) pointed out that, "in engagement, people employ and express themselves physically, cognitively, and emotionally during role performances", and "in disengagement, people withdraw and defend themselves physically, cognitively and emotionally during role performances". Engaged employees usually stay more involved in their jobs (physically, cognitively and emotionally) and also develop an energetic and effective connection with their work as compared to their disengaged co-workers (Kahn, 1990). Thus, job engagement denotes divergence among employees and the amount of energy and commitment they have for work (Kahn, 1990). This is due to incalculable importance for positive implications in organisations that job engagement literature continues to expand (Extremera *et al.*, 2012).

3.3 Affective organisational commitment

Employee commitment refers to the level of connection with an organisation (Meyer and Allen, 1997). Primarily, the sub-dimensions of commitment can be classified into three parts: affective, continuance and normative commitment. Out of all, only affective commitment covers the emotional links, identification, and involvement in the organisation and shows concerns attitudes towards the organisation as a whole (Meyer *et al.*, 2002). Allen and Meyer (1990) defined affective commitment as an emotional attachment to, identification with, and involvement in the organisation.

Table I The details of dimensions as proposed by Fisher (2010)

<i>The Targets for happy feelings</i>	<i>Characteristics</i>	<i>Corresponding dimension</i>
Work itself JE is defined as	Affective implication and feelings at work A special feeling of energy and motivation related to the capacity to be thrilled by and feel passionate about work	Job engagement (JE)
Job Characteristics JS is defined as	Evaluative judgments of job Characteristics, such as salary, supervision, career opportunities A reactive concept that captures feelings about working conditions, such as salary, career opportunities or relationship with peers	Job satisfaction (JS)
Organisation as a whole AOC refers to	Feelings of belonging to the organisation Feelings of affection and belonging to the organisation	Affective organisational commitment (AOC)

However, the continuance commitment is associated with guessed prices or expenses to the employee if she or he intends to leave the current organisation (Meyer and Allen, 1984), and normative commitment talks about the compulsory or an obligatory responsibility an employee perceived to continue with the present organisation (Allen and Meyer, 1990).

Affective commitment enjoys popularity among researchers and employers like job engagement. Both the constructs are highly beneficial for the employees' as well as organisational outcomes. The positive outcomes of both the constructs and terminology, often pose confusion between job engagement and affective commitment. Moreover, they have been proved to be separate constructs by researchers (Hallberg and Schaufeli, 2006).

3.4 Importance of happiness

Happiness is something we all keep running behind. In other words, it can be described as a high-priority goal of our lives (Diener, 2000). Happiness is such an important factor for everyone that the whole world cares about it, talks about it, irrespective of their varied religions, professions, status, education levels, etc. Happiness is a universal concept that has attracted researchers globally. This is the reason; the concept of happiness is widely acknowledged and respected phenomena by behavioural scientists and academic researchers. The global studies focused on happiness can support this notion suitably, for example, Sousa and Porto (2015) in Brazil; Krause (2013) in Germany; Williams *et al.* (2015) in Australia; Chaiprasit and Santidhiraku (2011) in Thailand; Swart and Rothmann (2012); and Field and Buitendach (2011) in South Africa.

From an organisational (employer) standpoint, optimistic mindset at work has been confirmed to encourage organisational productivity in different ways. Happiness is the reason why happier colleagues seem making more money and superior performance resulting into overall career success (Walsh *et al.*, 2018). In a German study, it was found that happiness has a strong significant relation with life outcomes such as reemployment (Krause, 2013). In a brief review of happiness and wellbeing in organisational behaviour domain, Rodríguez-Muñoz and Sanz-Vergel (2013) discussed that happiness augments well-being and positive affective experiences at work. In a Netherlands-based study de Waal (2018) established that boosted happiness at workplace levels significantly strengthen the attractiveness of the company (employer). Furthermore, empirical evidence provides proofs in support of happiness at the workplace as a key driver for extra-role behaviours such as organisational citizenship behaviour (OCB) in the organisation (Salas-Vallina, Alegre and Fernandez, 2017).

4. Research approach

4.1 Participants and procedure

The study aims to validate the S-HAW scale in India using knowledge workers. The prime asset of knowledge workers is their unique and specific knowledge. Certain professionals such as engineers, programmers, architects, scientists physicians, pharmacists, design thinkers, lawyers, and academicians, and any other white-collar workers, whose line of work requires the one to “think for a living” fall in the category of knowledge workers (Davenport, 2005). According to Massaro (2012), the knowledge-intensive workers are self-directed continuous learners who prefer challenging work, opportunities to pursue, problems to solve, feedback on their work, have own working schedules and may not necessarily be comfortable with imposed deadlines. Thus, the data were collected from full-time Doctors, Professors, Lawyers, and Engineers working in India. Potential respondents were approached with a positive friendly approach, and based on their preference of participation mode i.e., online or offline, they were offered a survey questionnaire. The advantage of using mixed-method approach in data collection is that it provides opportunities to fetch information from multiple sources in relatively easier and faster ways (Axinn and Pearce, 2006). Hence, out of 417, around 180 respondents exhibited interest in online participation in the survey, whereas 213 respondents showed interest in filling the questionnaire using the paper pen method. It was assumed that 24 employees were unwilling to participate in the survey. For survey process, a cover letter with the questionnaire clearly clarified the objective of the study to the participants. Participants were also assured of the confidentiality of their responses and secrecy of their identity.

Total 244 responses were obtained via online and offline modes. Out of 244 obtained filled responses, 18 were removed due to inadequacy such as missing responses, multiple responses, etc. Hence, only 226 responses were retained and further used in data analyses. Additionally, the option of feedback was also given for further improvement. The respondents in the study comprised of 70 per cent male and 30 per cent female respondents, with the majority of the participants mainly belonging to the age group of 30–36 years (40 per cent). About 72 per cent of the participants were married, whereas 25 per cent enjoyed single marital status. All the demographic characteristics are displayed in Table II.

4.2 Measure

As depicted in Table I, Fisher (2010) underlined the need to “distinguish three foci or targets for happy feelings: (1) the work itself; (2) the job, including its contextual features; and (3) the organisation as a whole” (p. 10). Proposing the dimensions conceptually is relatively easier, but it is also true that conceptualisation is of no use if there is no practical application of the theory. Hence, with an intention to foster practicality within the construct, Fisher (2010) stepped ahead and recommended the established constructs of job engagement, job satisfaction, and affective organisational commitment, for empirical investigation of above said dimensions. As stated by her, “these three measures together should capture much of the variance in person-level happiness in organisations” (Fisher, 2010, p. 10). Consequently, the present study selected the S-HAW instrument that is based on Fisher’s conceptualisation and satisfies all the essential criteria suggested by her. Accordingly, the second-order S-HAW instrument as suggested by Harrison *et al.* (2014) includes three dimensions: job engagement, job satisfaction, and affective organisational commitment with total nine items (Salas-Vallina and Alegre, 2018).

For job engagement, three items extending from 1 = “never” to 6 = “always” from the Utrecht Work Enthusiasm Scale (UWES) (Schaufeli *et al.*, 2002) were used. The three items for measuring Job satisfaction were adapted from Schriesheim and Tsui’s (1980) scale starting from 1 = “totally disagree”, to 5 = “totally agree”. The third construct, affective organisational commitment also consisted of three items (Allen and Meyer, 1990) using Likert scale from 1 = “totally disagree” to 5 = “totally agree”.

4.3 Analytic approach

In order to examine the psychometric properties of the S-HAW scale in the Indian context, factor structures, reliability and validity were examined with the help of SPSS AMOS 21. The study included initial descriptive analysis, item analysis, exploratory factor analysis (EFA) and confirmatory factor analysis (CFA).

Table II Demographic characteristics of research samples		
<i>Category</i>	<i>Frequency</i>	<i>(Approx. percentage)</i>
<i>Gender</i>		
Male	159	70.4
Female	67	29.6
<i>Age (in years)</i>		
22-26	50	22.1
27-31	91	40.3
32-36	68	30.1
37-41	16	7.1
42 and above	1	0.4
<i>Marital status</i>		
Married	162	71.7
Unmarried	57	25.2
Divorced or separated	7	3.1
Note: <i>n</i> = 226		

5. Results

5.1 Initial descriptive analysis

In order to confirm the normal distribution, the basic descriptive analyses were conducted considering the pattern and shape of the sample distribution. Consistent with the ranges of Skewness, i.e. score between 1, and Kurtosis, a value between 2 established normal distribution in the dataset (Hair *et al.*, 2006). As indicated in Table III, all sub-dimensions of the higher-order S-HAW construct were significantly correlated with an acceptable level of coefficients ranging from 0.131 to 0.538). It decreases the probability of multicollinearity violation in data sets (Hair *et al.*, 2006).

5.2 Item analysis

Cronbach's α scores were tested for examining the reliability of the instrument. The α coefficients for the happiness at workplace factors were 0.879 to job engagement (three items), 0.870 for job satisfaction (three items) and 0.768 for affective organisational commitment (three items). The values of the item analysis are given in Table IV. The originally developed European happiness at workplace measure also had a similar structure, where each of the three factors had three items.

5.3 The construct validity

5.3.1 Exploratory factor analysis. The original happiness at workplace scale was conceptually developed and empirically validated in the Western context using the sample from Italy and Spain. In the Indian setting, the factor structure of the items was empirically verified with the help of EFA using Maximum Likelihood Analysis using Promax with Kaiser Normalisation rotations. As the original measure of happiness at the workplace includes a total of nine items, the EFA included all happiness at workplace scale items. As observed in given EFA Table V, overall three factors were obtained reporting an Eigenvalue above 1. No cross-loadings were observed on any of the sub-constructs in Table V. It represents clear loadings of each item on their respective factors.

Table III Descriptive analyses

	Mean	SD	JS	JE	AOC
JS	3.8496	0.67840	1		
JE	4.0737	0.65128	0.538**	1	
AOC	2.8599	0.82942	0.131*	0.249**	1

Notes: JS, job satisfaction; JE, job engagement; AOC, affective organisational commitment

Table IV Item analysis table

Item	Scale mean if item deleted	Scale variance if item deleted	Corrected item-total correlation	Cronbach's α if Item deleted
AOC1	29.711	17.501	0.396	0.796
AOC2	29.111	17.813	0.387	0.796
AOC3	29.773	17.131	0.399	0.798
J_Eng1	28.507	18.028	0.502	0.779
J_Eng2	28.502	17.814	0.541	0.775
J_Eng3	28.604	17.803	0.533	0.775
J_Sat1	28.360	17.285	0.647	0.762
J_Sat2	28.307	17.767	0.591	0.770
J_Sat3	28.289	17.715	0.577	0.771

Notes: J_Eng, job engagement; J_Sat, job satisfaction; AOC, affective organisational commitment

Table V The value of Varimax rotation factor loading

	1	2	3
J_Eng2	0.920		
J_Eng1	0.887		
J_Eng3	0.684		
J_Sat2		0.893	
J_Sat3		0.854	
J_Sat1		0.737	
AOC2			0.801
AOC3			0.702
AOC1			0.683

Notes: J_Eng, job engagement; J_Sat, job satisfaction; AOC, affective organisational commitment. Extracted by maximum likelihood analysis. Rotated by Promax with Kaiser normalisation

5.3.2 Confirmatory factor analysis

5.3.2.1 Factor structures. CFA was performed for checking the structure of Shortened version of happiness at workplace (S-HAW) scale using knowledge workers' sample in Indian settings. Various models, for example, the original three-factors second-order model (M1), three-factors structure model (M2), two-factors model (M3), and single factor structure (M4) were tested in CFA. Among all tested models (M1–M4), the fit indices of M1 and M2 indicated superior results as compared to M3 and M4 as indicated from Table VI. More precisely, M1 (second-order three-factor structure) displayed slightly better model fit indices ($\chi^2(df = 24, n = 262) 34.667$, $\chi^2/df = 1.444$, IFI = 0.989, TLI = 0.980, CFI = 0.989) as compared to M2, the three-factor model. Figure 2 presents the factor structure of M1 (three-factor second order), whereas Figure 3 displays M2 (three-Factor first order), along with their respective significant factor loadings.

5.3.2.2 Convergent validity. The factor loadings of all measures were significant ($p < 0.001$) within the acceptable limits ranging from 0.677 to 0.918. For example, first-factor job engagement reveals factor loadings from 0.706 to 0.918; second-factor job satisfaction from 0.828 to 0.848, and last factor affective organisational commitment from 0.677 to 0.797. Considering given higher CR value and significant loadings in Table VII, the convergent validity is confirmed in the present study (Anderson and Gerbing, 1988; Bagozzi and Yi, 1988). Furthermore, the study reconfirmed convergent validity by indicating average variance extracted (AVE) greater than 0.5, and CR values greater than AVE values (Hair *et al.*, 2010). All values are depicted in Table VII.

5.3.2.3 Discriminant validity. For examination of discriminant validity, Fornell and Larcker (1981) suggested that the AVE value of every construct should be greater than the squared correlation coefficient with other constructs. Table VIII confirmed the discriminant validity.

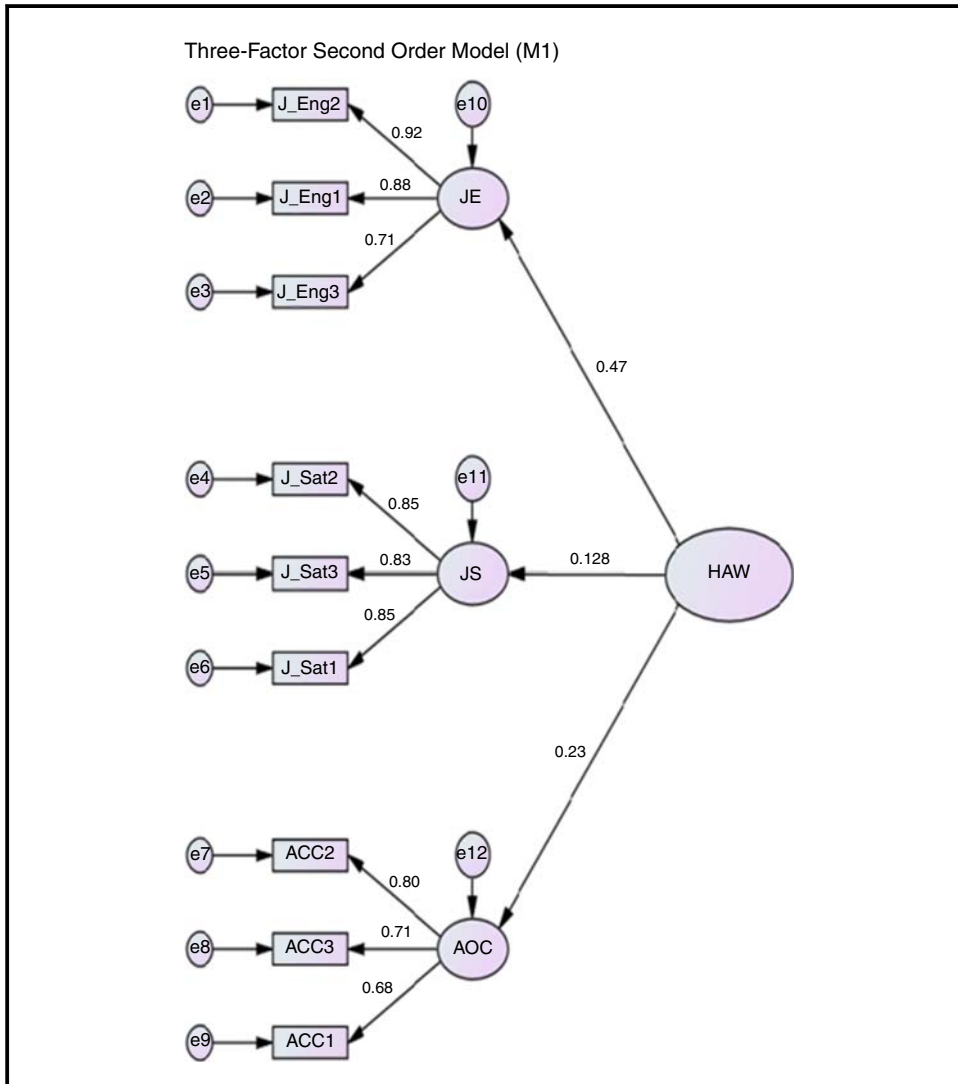
6. Discussion and conclusion

The study is conducted with the objective of validation of S-HAW scale by Salas-Vallina and Alegre (2018) in the Indian context. On the recommendation of Fisher the measurement included job engagement, job satisfaction, along with affective organisational commitment dimensions, whereas a second-order factor structure was retained as per the

Table VI Comparison of different model structures

Model fit indices	Label	χ^2	df	χ^2/df	RMSEA	IFI	TLI	CFI
Three-factor second-order model	M1	34.667	24	1.444	0.044	0.989	0.980	0.989
Three-factor model	M2	35.158	24	1.465	0.045	0.989	0.983	0.989
Two-factor Model (JE and JS combined)	M3	257.043	26	9.886	0.199	0.771	0.679	0.768
One-factor model	M4	418.402	27	15.496	0.254	0.611	0.477	0.608

Figure 2 Factor structure of M1 (three-Factor second order)



suggestions by researchers (Harrison *et al.*, 2014). The results acknowledged that the S-HAW measure has good construct validity based on empirical support for convergent and discriminant validity. The results confirm that the original scale by Salas-Vallina and Alegre (2018) is also a valid and reliable instrument in India.

With the advent of globalisation, technical innovations, and competitive business environments, the demands of work are changing as per the changes in the tastes of customers. Along with this, employers have also realised the secret of excelling in their businesses in such a highly competitive world by winning competitive advantage by means of talent. The secret is not as unique as any technical advancement but a mere transformation in attitudes of employers towards managing their talent. Now, most of the highly productive organisations are taking care of their employees by enhancing their happiness at the workplace. As research has identified that employers are involved in the promotion of their employees' happiness with a view to encouraging positive attitudes that are most likely to result in beneficial outcomes for the organisation (Smith, 2012).

Earlier, work-related happiness was considered to be an obligatory factor and was more confined to the developed economies because developing emerging economies were extra focused towards catering the basic-order needs such as food, shelter, clothes, and employment

Figure 3 Three factor structure M2 (three-Factor first order)

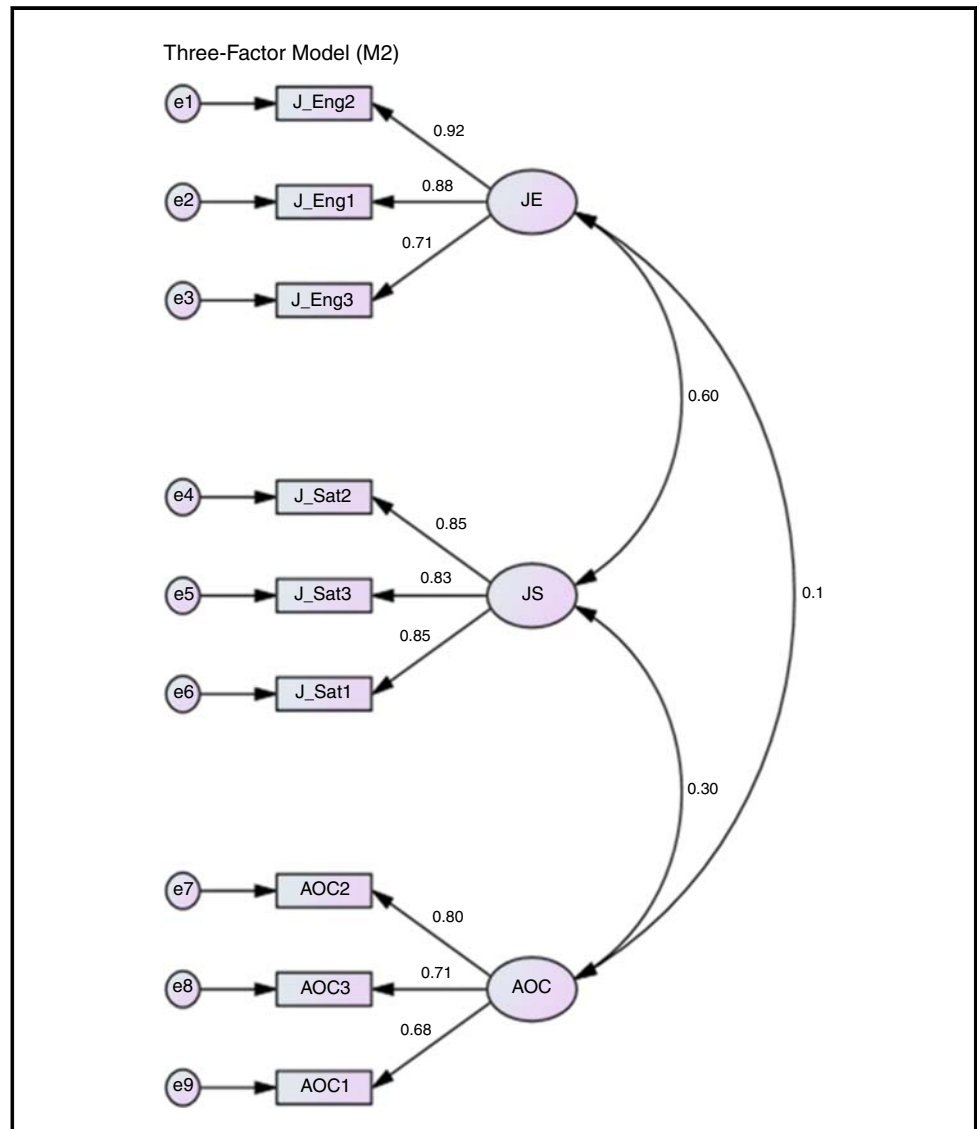


Table VII Reliability and validity assessment of the measure

Variables	Items	Coefficient	t-value	Cronbach's α	CR	AVE	MSV
JE	J_Eng2	0.918	0.918	0.879	0.877	0.706	0.362
	J_Eng1	0.881	0.881				
	J_Eng3	0.706	0.706				
JS	J_Sat2	0.847	0.847	0.870	0.879	0.707	0.362
	J_Sat3	0.828	0.828				
	J_Sat1	0.848	0.848				
AOC	AOC2	0.797	0.797	0.768	0.772	0.532	0.088
	AOC3	0.709	0.709				
	AOC1	0.677	0.677				

Notes: JE, job engagement; JS, job satisfaction; AOC, affective organisation commitment, CR, composite reliability; AVE, average variance extracted; MSV, maximum shared variance

Table VIII Discriminant validity analysis

Factor	JS	JE	AOC
JS	0.841		
JE	0.602	0.840	
AOC	0.297	0.108	0.729
Notes: JE, job engagement; JS, job satisfaction; AOC, affective organisation commitment			

of their people. More recently, with the advent of globalisation, entry of MNCs and India's stand at international business front brought a drastic change in culture in India where being happy at work also emerged as a foremost concern of the Indian employers along with global ones.

Given the background of diverse work value system, the study risked using the original theoretical background of happiness at workplace concept that is developed in a Western context. Surprisingly, adhering to the basic human behaviour dynamics which signify positive things give happiness whereas negative make people sad, the final results of the study verified the psychometric properties in S-HAW measurement in different culture. One of the reasons for this could ascribe to the fact that the original scale was being prepared and validated in Spanish settings, and considering the Hofstede's cultural comparison between Spain and India, it was observed that both countries' score on individualism, masculinity, and more specifically long-term orientation. These three dimensions play a fundamental role in forming work-related perceptions in life. Thus, this validation of higher order S-HAW scale with just nine items proved to be a strategic benefit for the Indian happiness literature with abundant functional benefits. Such as the development of the Indian version of comprehensive yet short happiness at workplace scale would encourage academic researchers as well as behavioural scientists to conduct abundant future happiness at workplace-related studies within the Indian context. Additionally, this would promote researchers to combine various individual or organisational factors such as enhanced productivity, innovative work behaviour, OCB, and see their relationship with happiness at the workplace in cross-cultural contexts.

Since the advent of the open economy coupled with globalisation in 1990, India witnessed speedy industrialisation and modernisation of the society (Nigam, 2017; Jha, 2018). Subsequently, the population in India has experienced many changes in the lifestyle and food habits, social systems, thinking patterns, norms, and work values. Regardless of these above said fluctuations, however, it is argued that the traditional family value system generally dominates Indian culture easily observed in the work domain. The family continues to take the central place and influence the career-related decisions in Indian society such as which company to join or which location to join are some questions that are greatly influenced by family even today (Hatun, 2013).

7. Managerial implications

Happiness at workplace has developed a well-acknowledged research domain in the Western world countries. Though happiness is a critical part of non-western societies, yet in terms of research, happiness, especially at the workplace, is still a relatively new domain outside the western nations. This is one of the reasons that very few studies are reported in the Indian context (Singh and Aggarwal, 2018). Thus, the study has the following implications for managers, and employees.

As a very popular construct of positive organisational behaviour happiness at workplace is thought to be a highly influential factor in enhancing employee's performance and overall organisational outcomes (Walsh *et al.*, 2018; de Waal, 2018; Salas-Vallina, Alegre and Fernandez, 2017). In this respect, happiness at workplace has become an important concern for employers that posed a question to academic researchers especially, "What kind of factors

inspire happiness at workplace among employees?” Demonstrating a closely-knit family culture of collectivist society, as a representative of collectivist Asian culture, India is proved to be an apt choice for validating a happiness at workplace instrument. With validation, this study welcomes the entry of S-HAW scale in Asian cultures.

The validation S-HAW instrument is the opening step towards the happiness focussed empirical studies. For academic researchers and managers, this Indian version of the S-HAW scale can be a useful tool to detect performance, absenteeism, turnover, and motivation related problems of the workplace of the organisation so that they can recommend the judicious and suitable organisational interventions to address employee-related problems in the organisation.

Additionally, availability of this short S-HAW instrument is more likely to encourage the happiness literature in the Non-western context. Investigation of S-HAW would enable behavioural scientists and organisational practitioners to provide enhanced solutions for organisational productivity by articulating employee wellbeing focused policies with an intention to promote happiness, rather than just merely reducing the grievances in organisations. Apart from that, this validation would enable not only the assessment of levels of happiness at work but also provide a uniform platform for examining happiness at work in Western countries and India. Thus, this validation successfully enables the comparison of happiness levels at work among employees across cultures.

From the perspective of employees also, this study has ample implications. As one of the biggest outsourcing locations, the 5th most preferred investment destination, with advanced manpower characterised with excellent English-speaking skills, cheap wages, and higher skills, India plays a remarkable strategic role in business fraternity across the globe. This coupled with open door policy enticed many MNCs to set up their functions in India as well, where recruitment is conducted using a localisation process bearing talent availability and affordability in mind. In such circumstances, the availability of this short version of happiness at workplace scale would enable the multinational employers to develop an insight regarding the overall well-being of their Indian employees by examining the levels of their HAW. The timely examination of happiness at the workplace provides a sense of “being listened to or taken care of” among employees.

8. Limitations and future scope for research

This study acknowledges some limitations as well that are needed to be addressed in future studies. First, the study has not translated the instrument in Hindi language. The written constitution of India Republic establishes the proclamation of Hindi as well as English as the official languages of the nation. Apart from the official language, English is widely spoken and understood as an integral part of the education curriculum and mode of instruction mostly all across the nation, whereas Hindi-speaking zones are relatively restricted (e.g. New Delhi, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, etc.). The popularity of English as compared to Hindi is well-recognised, in fact, there are Indian states where no Hindi but English and vernacular languages (e.g. Tamil) are entitled to be used even in Central government’s official work. Hence, the English language measure was understandable to the respondents, and no need was felt to translate the measure (Rastogi *et al.*, 2016). Second, the data were collected with the help of self-reported measures from a single source that enhances the chances of common method variance in the obtained data. Mentioning the issue of CMV in validation, Storm and Rothmann (2003) cited in their study (Schaufeli *et al.*, 2002), “in validation studies at least part of the common variance of the measures has to be attributed to method variance” (p. 69). Third, the study included only 30 per cent of women, whereas 70 per cent of participants were male. The similar kind of male gender dominated studies is also witnessed in earlier studies in the Indian context (Rastogi *et al.*, 2018, 2019). Hence, there is a need to use the more gender-balanced sample in future studies. Fourth, this study was conducted using the organisational perspective that focused only on the happiness of employees at work. In the future, more studies are required to prepare a measure to cater the happiness of employees beyond the workplace.

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Further reading

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